

**Regular Meeting
Monday, December 17, 2018
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mr. Ruggiero, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Ms. Caldwell, and Assistant Superintendent of Finance Ms. Patterson.

Mayor Burke – Called meeting to order at 7:04 PM, Secretary please call the roll.

Attendance – 7 – present 0 – absent

Mayor Burke - I would like to welcome the string orchestra who will be playing music for us this evening. Mr. Szykniej - We will play Jingle Bells, composed by James Pierpont right down the street here in Medford Square. We wish you happy holidays. General thank yous from all members.

Approval of Minutes of December 3, 2018 – Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we include that there should be a status report about the 501(c)3 groups at the end of February? Motion to approve minutes as amended offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. Roll call vote - 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes.

Approval of payrolls - Ms. DiBenedetto - On page 14, there are two charges of exactly the same amount. Ms. Patterson - Yes, that is correct. It is reimbursement of travel expenses. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. Roll call vote - 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes.

Report of Secretary - Ms. Kreatz - I wanted to share that last week I signed off on an invoice to pay for a class held by Miranda Wilson from the Medford Transcript. She taught students a workshop on writing and publishing a newspaper article. Motion to approve and place on file by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report of Committees - Buildings and Grounds Subcommittee - Ms. Mustone - This meeting on November 29 was a follow up from our meeting last May. We did updates on security and safety at the high school. The meeting had good representation of people in the high school building. Officer Ziobro attends community-based justice meetings. Safe Havens report was reviewed, will not be shared with the public. Cameras are fixed or being fixed. There are 95 cameras on the high school campus. Doors are all being marked from outside. Safety care for kids in crisis. We also discussed feminine hygiene products in high school bathrooms. Mr. Ruseau - I have some follow-up questions about the sanitary materials in bathrooms. Ms. Caldwell - Thank you for bringing this to our attention earlier. We have worked with CCSR members to be sure we are

responsive to the needs of students. Toni Wray and John McLaughlin and I got together to resolve the issue. We will order 5 product dispensers that are free and place them in the bathrooms. C building floors 1, 2, 3, in the bathrooms outside of C building. Vocational school on second floor, plus the girls gym area. Products will be free. Buildings and Grounds will supply and build dispensers. It will cost about \$950. Students can also go to the nurse's office if they're nearby. According to Toni Wray we can't do tampons, but we can do free pads. Mr. Ruseau - Lots of progress, thank you. Is Toni Wray here? Ms. Caldwell - No. Mr. Ruseau - New York State mandated that all bathrooms have free pads and tampons in every public school in the state. I'm hopeful my work with the legislature will result in progress on that. If the legislation changes will we keep using the same equipment? Ms. Caldwell - Hopefully not. Mr. Ruseau - Will they be outside the Assistant Principal's office? Ms. Caldwell - No, in the bathroom. Mr. Ruseau - How long do they have to walk to get to them? Ms. Caldwell - A couple of minutes. Mr. Ruseau - Why can't we do tampons? It seems like we are making a decision for girls about what they can use. I don't think that's a decision for the school system. Ms. Caldwell - We can have a follow up conversation with Ms. Wray. Ms. Mustone - Is it because of toxic shock syndrome? Maybe schools don't feel comfortable with the liability. Mr. Ruseau - Not having them seems to be setting ourselves up for liability because it's about frequency of changing them. Mayor Burke - Ms. Caldwell is going to check with nursing. Ms. Van der Kloot - We got an email before the meeting tonight about why we are not providing both pads and tampons. If the machine does not support it there is always a little basket. We are making progress. Let's see how it goes but our objective should be to provide the supplies throughout all schools. Ms. Caldwell - You mean middle schools as well? Ms. Van der Kloot - That would be my objective. Can you get back to us on that? Ms. Mustone - John McLaughlin said the dispensers have spaces for both. Motion to accept as is and revisit in January and Ms. Wray to clarify on tampons by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Rules Subcommittee - Ms. Kreatz - We met last week and discussed final copy of our document The Function of the School Committee. We are still struggling with number 5. Between last meeting and this meeting I met with City Solicitor Mark Rumley on wording. We talked about what possible consequences would be for a school committee member that is in violation of policies. We voted on a new final draft with updates to number 5 and some different wording because of trying to not be in violation of law and the first amendment. We will put this version on school letterhead and sign it at another meeting. Mayor Burke - Committee of the Whole meeting or to the floor? Ms. Kreatz - It's supposed to be key functions not policies. Meaning it's not everything we do, it's the key components. If we want to do Committee of the Whole we can and discuss in January or February. We took out some language that was in violation of the first amendment. Ms. DiBenedetto - I don't love number 5. Who decides what is unbecoming? Censure - I don't report to my fellow members, I report to people who voted for me to be their voice, so I would remove number 5 totally. I wouldn't sign off on this with that. I think people would have a hard time censoring me anyway. That's my job as a committee member, to speak my mind for the people who elected me. I think it's dangerous to include and impossible to regulate it. Mr. Ruggiero - We spent a lot of time thinking about the idea of consequences. According to Robert's Rules of Order we have the authority now to censure a person who is acting unbecoming. The idea is you are responsible to the citizens of Medford, so we wanted to add some element, we debated quite a bit, we decided there should be a provision for a member

that acts in violation otherwise it's a piece of paper. Mayor Burke - MASC talks about guidelines of what we are and how to bring us back if we go astray. Censure to me is a harsh word but I recall her saying that. I would be interested in hearing from some other communities that have done this. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - This is a combination of lots of other school committee documents that we have read that other communities use. We can revisit this in another retreat or Committee of the Whole. Mayor Burke - Motion that we send the document to Committee of the Whole by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Ms. Van der Kloot - Before you call the roll, I have one sentence to look at. Mayor Burke - It will go to Committee of the Whole. Roll call vote, 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes.

Community Relations Subcommittee - Mr. Ruggiero - We are looking at more community involvement and volunteering. We discussed digital documents being posted online. Many parents have asked me to post. As a committee we hoped to have a unified policy. We spoke with Dorothy Presser, representative from MASC. They have no official position on digital documents being posted online, but she hasn't heard any negative feedback from communities that do it. A sizeable minority do this. All the communities I spoke with responded positively. The idea was we would send a link to school committee members first, then send link to community at large. We wouldn't send presentations or superintendent notes, just PDFs of reports. They recommended we do a trial period first. We voted to do a similar program to what they do in Franklin. 12pm on Friday a link is sent to all school committee members, 4pm it is sent to the community at large. Mayor Burke - Is that in the committee report? Mr. Ruggiero - We haven't voted on the minutes. Mayor Burke - So you're sending it back to committee? Ms. Van der Kloot - You don't have minutes for this meeting? Mr. Ruggiero - You need the minutes? Ms. Van der Kloot - There's one piece we need to report out because of the time constraint. The subcommittee suggested that we provide an opportunity for the community to have a meet and greet for school committee members. Medford Family Network Valentine's Day ice cream social. We would do a meet and greet the hour before. I spoke to Marie Cassidy and she understood and said that if we were to proceed on it she can put a line in her flier about it. Mayor Burke - We have a motion for school committee to have a meet and greet the day of the MFN ice cream social? Mr. Ruggiero - I'm confused about logistics. We haven't voted on our last meeting. Mayor Burke - You vote at the end of your meeting. Mr. Ruggiero - We voted for this all to go to the whole committee. 1. Meet and greet, 2. Digital documents. Mayor Burke - I don't have a report. Ms. DiBenedetto - There are two items, I second having the meet and greet in February, Valentine's Day social. Motion to do a meet and greet an hour before the Medford Family Network Valentine's Day Ice Cream Social by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes. Motion to accept report of the subcommittee and place on file by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Community Participation - City wide PTO representatives Kristy Avino, Jenny Graham. Ms. Avino - We are excited to officially conclude the Disney raffle. Before we announce the winner, thank you to all who helped support us in this process. Special thanks to Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Mayor Burke's office, Medford's recreation department, and the principals of the four elementary schools. We sold 4,824 tickets. Gross sales were over \$24,000. After we pay taxes and fees, each school will receive \$4,000. Grand prize winner will get a \$5,000 Disney vacation. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The first place winner is Lynn Freitas of Medford. The second place prize

is a \$250 Disney gift card. The winner is Maura Kennedy of Medford. Thank you very much!
Mayor Burke - Kudos to all of you and thank you for all you have done for our schools.

Ms. DiBenedetto - I have a note from the daughter of Lena DiGianntomaso about the event we held at the high school. She is very grateful, it was a successful event.

Carolyn Montello - I wanted to bring up the issue of heat at the high school. After a few recent very cold visits to the theater and gym, I was told the theater heat is broken and a part is coming, and the gym has only one part working and the other three are gone? I have heard there is a problem at the pool and I have heard that some students have to wear their coats inside. In one classroom students are allowed to bring blankets because it's so cold. I think most parents believe that schools are heated in the winter. I would like to ask the committee to motion to immediately audit the current heating system at the high school and provide an update. So moved by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. Mayor Burke - The theater is going to be fixed over winter break at the latest. The gym has 2 out of 4 heaters working now. Ms. Montello - People have coats on in the gym. Mayor Burke - We have been there recently and it seemed ok but we will have an audit. Motion passes.

Report of Superintendent - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The Lena DiGianntomaso music room dedication was a success. The plaque is in place now and thank you to all involved. The Center for Citizenship and Social Responsibility: Our students have been busy. Medford High students have been visiting with younger students to discuss roles and objectives. Assisted by Retta Smith and the Garden Club they planted the new orchard. They are also collecting Toys for Tots. Spanish 2 Honors class have Skyped with students in Bolivia and practiced conversational Spanish. Voke Chest food pantry, Priscilla's Pantry, is now available to all students and free of charge. It is currently open Thursdays after school 2:30-3:30 with hopes of expanding hours in near future. It is located next to the third floor lecture hall in C Building. Thanks to the Hoff Family Foundation, Greater Boston Food Bank, Malden YMCA, Retta Smith, and the other teachers who helped put this together. It is a good example of collaboration that benefits our students and families. Empowering Girls Conference: 8th graders from the Andrews attended the conference in Lexington. It was hosted by Middlesex DA Marian Ryan. It's an all-day program for middle school girls. The theme was "She Persisted." The students listened to guest speakers, asked questions, participated, and felt empowered and invigorated about their futures. Sports: the winter sports season has officially begun. LeConte ice rink is offering expanded public skating, which is all listed on the website and blog. My focus is on instruction. I'm trying to stay with my goal of being in schools observing instruction twice a week. It's really uplifting to see how devoted our teachers are. Earlier today I was at the Columbus and spent time with one of our math coaches, improving math performance is one of our goals and a serious focus of mine. ACE: Advisors and Coaches in Education. ACE is a program in the middle schools of the Medford health department, Team Medford, and Medford Public Schools. We educate and train club advisors and coaches on how to effectively use evidence-based models to help reduce substance abuse and risky behaviors in youth. We already have ACE in high school so this is for middle schools. Security update: We met in a closed-door meeting to examine Safe Havens and discussed where we stand on keeping Medford Schools safe. Last week our officers attended safety workshops put on by Safe Havens. They reported out and shared with our principals.

MSBA: the Massachusetts School Building Authority awarded 14 districts with a grant for capital improvements, unfortunately Medford was not one of them. We will continue to apply for funding to renovate the high school complex. We will continue to work collaboratively with the city on targeted capital improvement projects. Vaping – This is a serious concern that the country is facing, Medford is not excluded. We take it very seriously as a district and as a city. School administration is very aware of the public health issues and how it's affecting our students and community. A brief overview of what we have done thus far: with a focus on the whole child we have engaged in student education, abiding by the Michigan model. We offer student support to assist students at risk and engaging in risky behaviors, we have forged community partnerships with the Medford Board of Health, and we are continuing ongoing outreach and education for parents and staff. We will also be providing space for a parent support group that could be available to parents at the high school. A more comprehensive report is coming in January, we are inviting Dr. Schuster who has already done a presentation to administrators and directors. Today I had the pleasure of being at the Roberts and I was invited to see their hand chimes concert. Mr. Connors is masterful, our arts department as a district is phenomenal. Thank you to the Roberts for that. Wish you all a happy holiday season, a restful break, Hanukkah has ended but happy Hanukkah, merry Christmas, happy kwanzaa and happy new year to all. Ms. Van der Kloot - There also was an incredibly great middle school concert last Thursday. Our new school select ensemble has been gold medal winners at all levels. They really did a terrific job, Ms. Chang is a fantastic teacher.

Planting of Orchard - Prabidhi Rana and Caelee Bouley, student presenters. A lovely orchard was planted by students at the high school. The interior courtyard was chosen as the location of the orchard. We enjoyed the project and plan to continue in the spring so teachers can hold classes outside. Teachers of various disciplines can use the orchard for instruction. Mayor Burke - We are so happy this came to fruition. You had some setbacks but you kept going, thank you. Ms. DiBenedetto - Was the concern the deer? Ms. Caldwell - That was part of it. Also the bear. The courtyard seemed like a happy solution. Ms. DiBenedetto - The courtyard needed sprucing up. Motion to accept the report and place on file by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report on Botball - Medford High School robotics team has received a donation of \$2,000 from Mide Technologies to participate in a robotics competition. Mayor Burke - Thank you to Mide for partnering, they came through again. They work with our McGlynn students and have been a great corporate partner. Motion to approve donation for entering the Botball robotics competition by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. Roll call, 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes. Ms. DiBenedetto - Thank you to Barbara Chyen for your time and effort with this group. The reason they have been so successful is because of your dedication to our schools. Faiza Khan - Thank you for acknowledging Ms. Chyen. She has worked so hard.

Report on Advanced Placement honor. Ms. Caldwell - Medford has been honored by Advanced Placement for increasing access to AP to underrepresented students and continuing to produce students getting AP scores of 3 or higher. Medford has increased the number of students over the past 3 years while increasing or maintaining the percentage of students earning 3 or higher on AP

exams. This is quite an honor for Medford High. Motion to accept the report and place on file by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Foss Science Curriculum. Roll call vote, 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes.

Ms. Mustone - Officer Bill Mazaka was present at the Buildings and Grounds subcommittee meeting and I forgot to mention it.

Mr. Ruseau - Question about MSBA application. Do we get feedback? Ms. Patterson - I did call them directly and inquired if there was something we could do with the application or terminology that can be more aggressive, the short answer is no, each year it's a new year, there are districts that have been filing since 2008. It's a matter of significant need, enrollment factors, conditions of buildings needing projects. Only a small amount of awards are issued based on how much funding is available. There are accelerated projects available for roof, boiler and windows only. We keep our capital improvement listing. We did find with the merger of the Voke and high school that we may have some we can submit. Submissions go in for February, March, and April. Ms. Van der Kloot - One of the concerns brought to us is the heating in the gym. I've always been concerned with the windows. Have we included them in the submission? Mayor Burke - That was a full program, not the separate program just for windows. Ms. Patterson - The heating is the whole HVAC system. Mayor Burke - But it's not the boilers, it's all the other parts. Ms. Mustone - Did they tell you which districts were funded? Ms. Patterson - They will be listed.

Condolences to the family of Julie Green, sister of Representative Christine Barber.

Mayor Burke - Motion to adjourn. 8:27PM.

Merry Christmas and we look forward to seeing you next year.